
Lecture

Experience Economy JTBD Framework

Julee Hyunju Lee

Adjunct Faculty

User-Centred Collaborative Design

College of Design & Engineering

National University of Singapore

Jan 19, 2026

Recap //

Designing Innovative Products

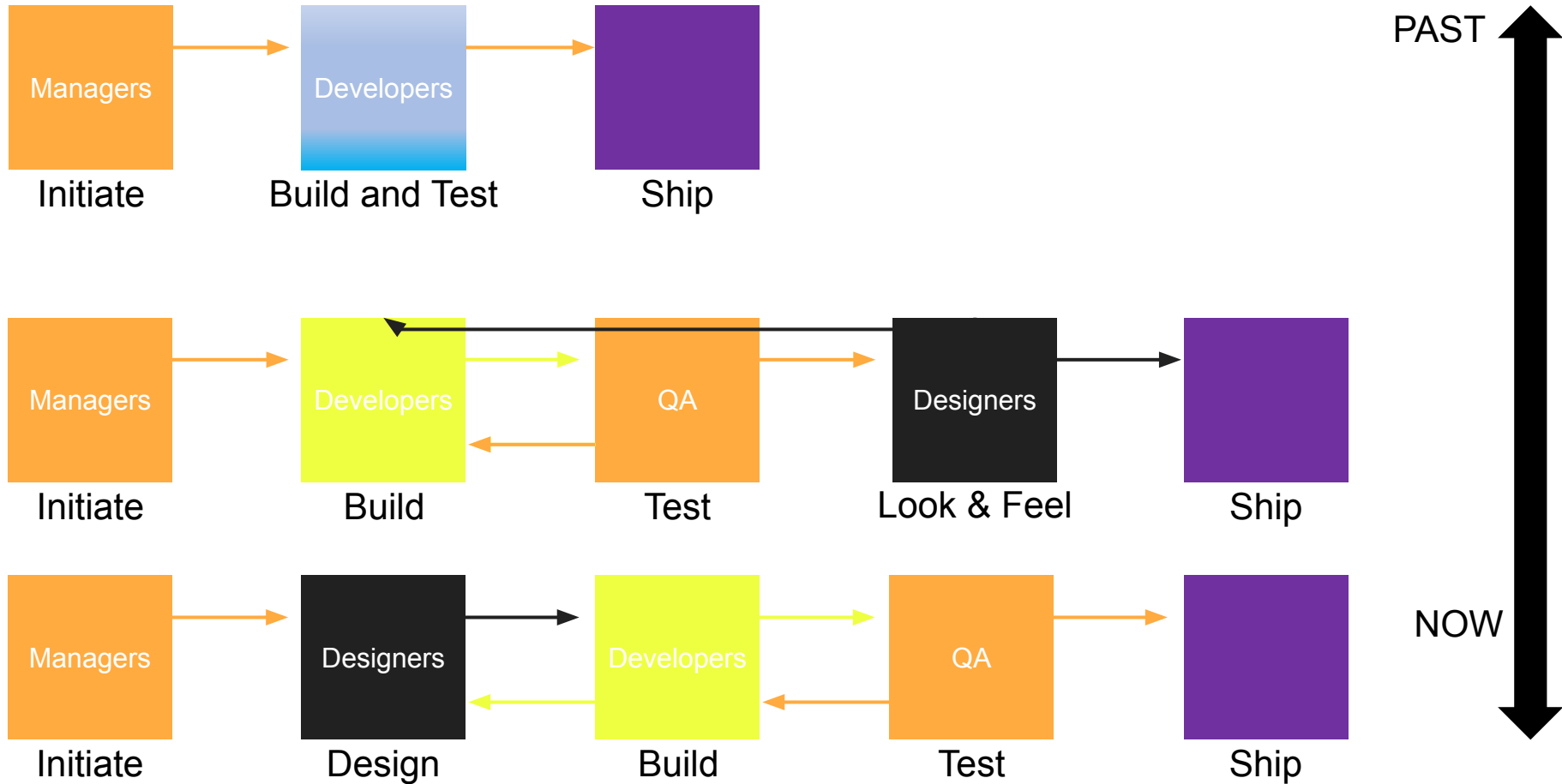


This course is about

designing
innovative
products.



Design **used to be an after-thought** for beautifying already-established ideas/products, so that users would buy.



**MAKING
USERS
WANT
SOMETHING**

(old-way of thinking
about design)

**MAKING
SOMETHING
USERS
WANT**

(design for innovation)



This course is about
designing
innovative
products.

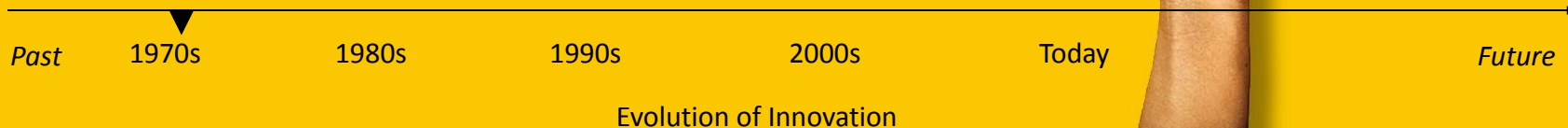
The focus
was on
Product.



Polaroid
has changed
the way we
interact with
photography.



Hardware



The focus
was on
Electronics Product.

SONY



Sony has changed
the way we listened
to music.

Past

1970s

1980s

1990s

2000s

Today

Future

Evolution of Innovation

Electronics
+
Hardware

The focus
was on
Software.



Microsoft has
changed the way we
work with computer.

Hardware

Electronics
+
Hardware

Software
+
Electronics
+
Hardware

Past

1970s

1980s

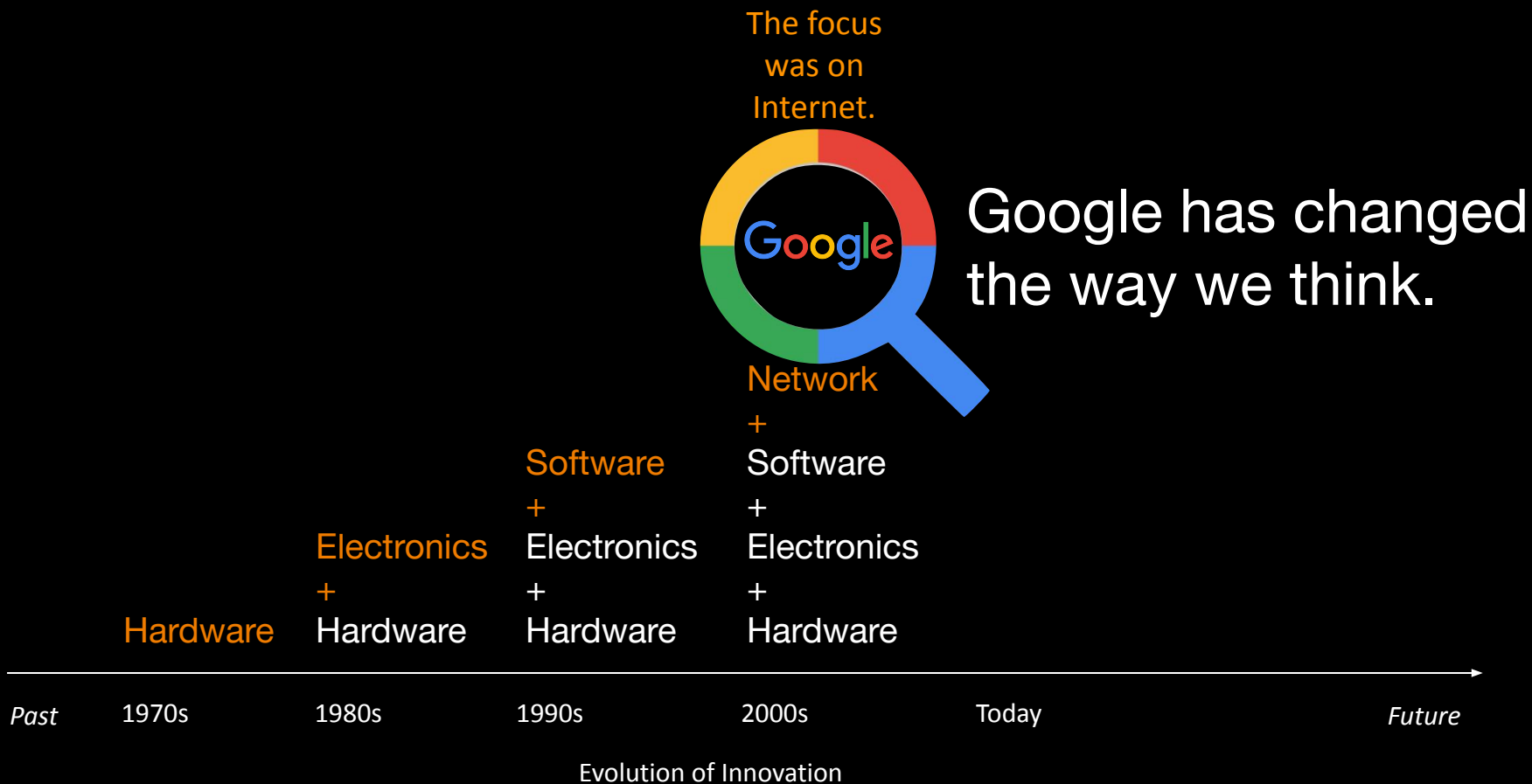
1990s

2000s

Today

Future

Evolution of Innovation



Apple has changed the way we live.

The focus
is on
Experience.



Experience

+

Network

+

Software

+

Electronics

+

Hardware

Network

+

Software

+

Electronics

+

Hardware

Software

+

Electronics

+

Hardware

Electronics

+

Hardware

Hardware

Past

1970s



1980s

1990s

2000s

Today

Future

Evolution of Innovation

The focus was on Product.

The focus was on Electronics Product.

The focus was on Software.

The focus was on Internet.

The focus is on Experience.

Hardware

Electronics
+
Hardware

Software
+
Electronics
+
Hardware

Network
+
Software
+
Electronics
+
Hardware

Experience

+

Network
+
Software
+
Electronics
+
Hardware

The Differentiator

Supporting the creation of experiences

Past

1970s

1980s

1990s

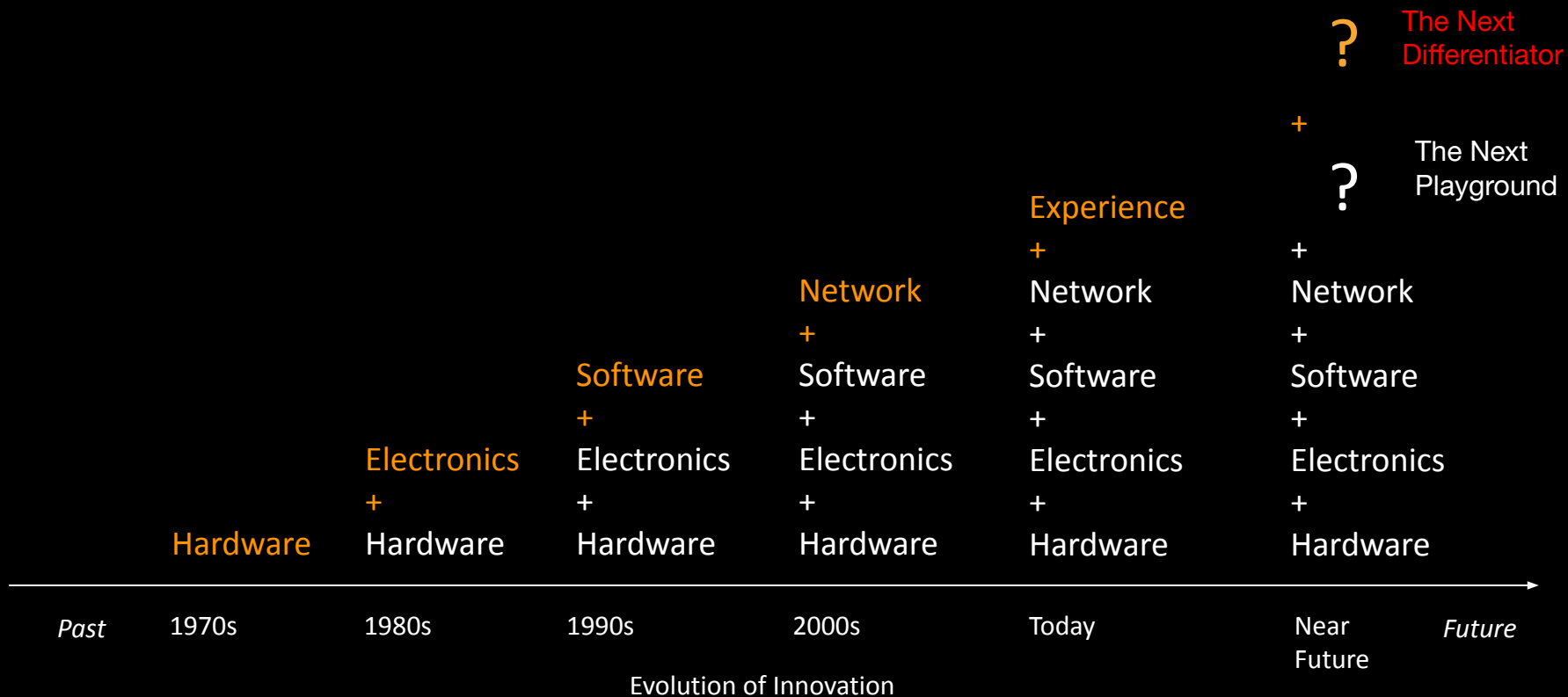
2000s

Today

Near Future

Future

Evolution of Innovation



Users buy this.

Experience

+

Network

+

Software

+

Electronics

+

Hardware

Users do not buy these
(but expect they are
there).

A close-up photograph of a magnifying glass held over an open dictionary. The lens is centered on the definition of the word 'focus'. A green highlighter is visible, having just finished highlighting the word 'focus'. The text is slightly blurred outside the lens's field of view.

Focus on the **experiences**
that users are craving for.



This course is about
designing
innovative
products.

Users do not want
a camera ...



... or photos

...

... they want
memory sharing
experiences.





Users do not want
DVD collection ...

... or movies

...



...they want
great movie
experiences.





iPhone killed over 27 products.

You don't develop a FILM anymore.

You don't need a PORTABLE NAVIGATION DEVICE anymore.

You don't need a MEMO RECORDER anymore.

You don't need a CAMCORDER anymore.

You don't need a COMPASS anymore.

You don't need a FLASHLIGHT anymore.

You don't need an ALARM CLOCK anymore.

etc.

It's all on the iPhone!

Experience Economy

The Big Picture

We have moved to the

Experience Economy

*Photo Credit:
Starbucks*



Starbucks Reserve
Roastery New York



The Facade

*Photo Credit:
Starbucks*

Starbucks Reserve
Roastery New York

STARBUCKS RESERVE® ROASTERY NEW YORK

ARRIVIAMO[®]
BAR

The Map

Starbucks Reserve
Roastery New York

Photo Credit: Adam Campbell-Schmitt
(www.foodandwine.com)



The Inside

*Photo Credit:
Starbucks*

Starbucks Reserve
Roastery New York



The Merchandise

Photo Credit:
Starbucks

Starbucks Reserve
Roastery New York



The Experience Bar

Photo Credit:
Starbucks

Starbucks Reserve
Roastery New York



The Starbucks Reserve Roastery

*Photo Credit:
Starbucks*



Starbucks Reserve
Roastery New York



The Coffee Bean Shop

*Photo Credit:
Starbucks*

Starbucks Reserve
Roastery New York



ISPIRARE È
UNA PERSONA.
UN CAFFÈ.
UN QUARTIERE
ALLA VOLTA.

A CITTÀ DEDICATA AL CAFFÈ
OGNI CUCINA HA IL SUO
CAFFÈ TOSTATO GIUSTO.

R



Starbucks Reserve
Roastery Milan

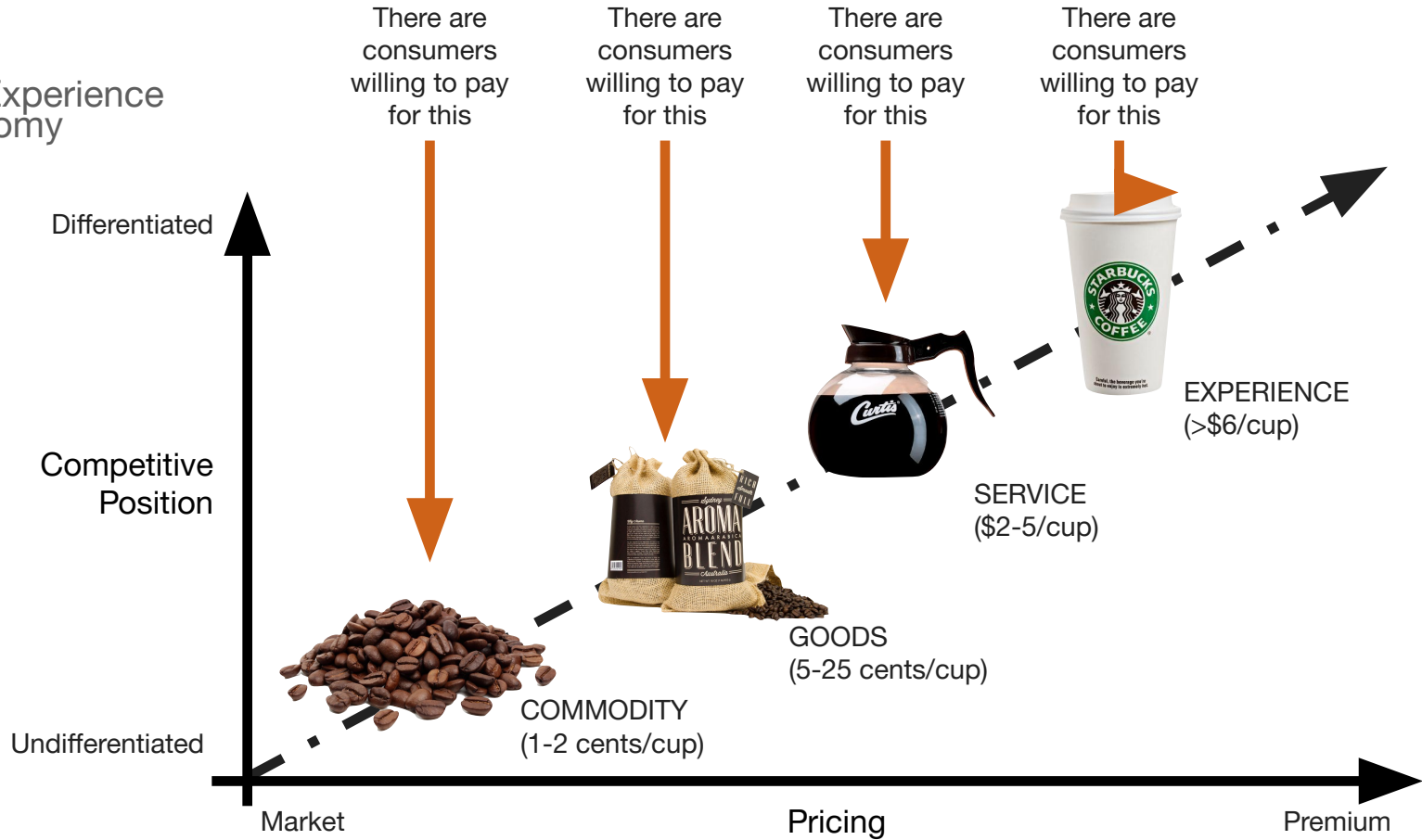
Photo Credit:
Starbucks



*Photo Credit:
Starbucks*

Starbucks Reserve Roastery Tokyo

The Experience Economy



Consumers
don't want
a piece of
programming...

```
return a.test(t)
```

```
function parse_details(t, a) {  
  var o = {};  
  try {  
    o = JSON.parse(t.data("details"));  
  } catch (r) {}  
  return "undefined" == typeof a ? a : o;  
}
```

```
function parseJSON(t) {  
  if ("object" != typeof t) try {  
    t = JSON.parse(t)  
  } catch (a) {  
    t = {}  
  }  
}
```



...they want
great digital experiences.

*Photo Credit:
Thierry Do*



Consumers don't want
an engine...



...they want
great driving experiences.

*Photo Credit:
Thierry Do*

JTBD Framework

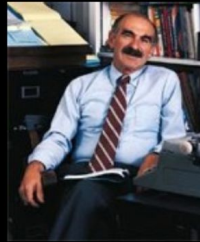
- 1 What is JTBD
- 2 Case Studies
- 3 JTBD Framework
- 4 Exercise One: Understand Needs
- 5 Exercise Two: JTBD Interview & Job Statement

- 1. What is JTBD**
2. Case Studies
3. JTBD Framework
4. Exercise 1: Understand Needs
5. Exercise 2: JTBD Interview & Job Statement

What is JTBD?

The Jobs-To-Be-Done framework is an approach to developing products based on understanding both the customer's specific goal, or “job” and the thought processes that would lead that customer to “hire” a product to complete the job.

Jobs-to-be-done is a framework for **innovation**
developed by **business** experts
(not specific to web design)



Theodore Levitt

Economist



Anthony Ulwick

Business consultant



Clayton Christensen

Economist



Philosophy behind JTBD:

People have problems they need help solving, and they “hire” products or services to do the job of solving their problems.

**CUSTOMERS DON'T BUY
PRODUCTS OR BRANDS.
THEY “HIRE” SOLUTIONS
THAT GET JOBS DONE.**

Clayton Christensen, HBS

“The job is the fundamental unit of analysis for developing products that customers will buy.”

Clayton Christensen, JTBD Workshop



A ‘Job-To-Be-Done’ = a unit of value to your user base

Understand all the jobs in our product space, so we can decide and prioritise which jobs our products should do, which ones “we (as a company)” will be most hired for if we do the job well.

Think of it as a perspective or approach

“Jobs-to-be-done is a perspective. When looking through a Jobs-to-be-Done lens, customers, markets, needs, segments and opportunities look different”

- Anthony Ulwich



People buy products and services to help them get a job done

The “job” - not the product or the customers - is the unit of analysis

A “job” lens brings a new perspective to strategy and innovation

Jobs remain valid over time.
What changes is the solution
people use to get it done.

**They hire a product or
service to get the job done.**

1. What is JTBD
- 2. Case Studies**
3. JTBD Framework
4. Exercise 1: Understand Needs
5. Exercise 2: JTBD Interview & Job Statement





Adding
Features
In Product?

Focus Group
Study?

Market
Segment
Comparison
?

First,
Use Data
What it tells

Second,
OBSERVE
the
customers

Then,
INTERVIEW
about the
purchase

Allowed
out-of-box
solutions

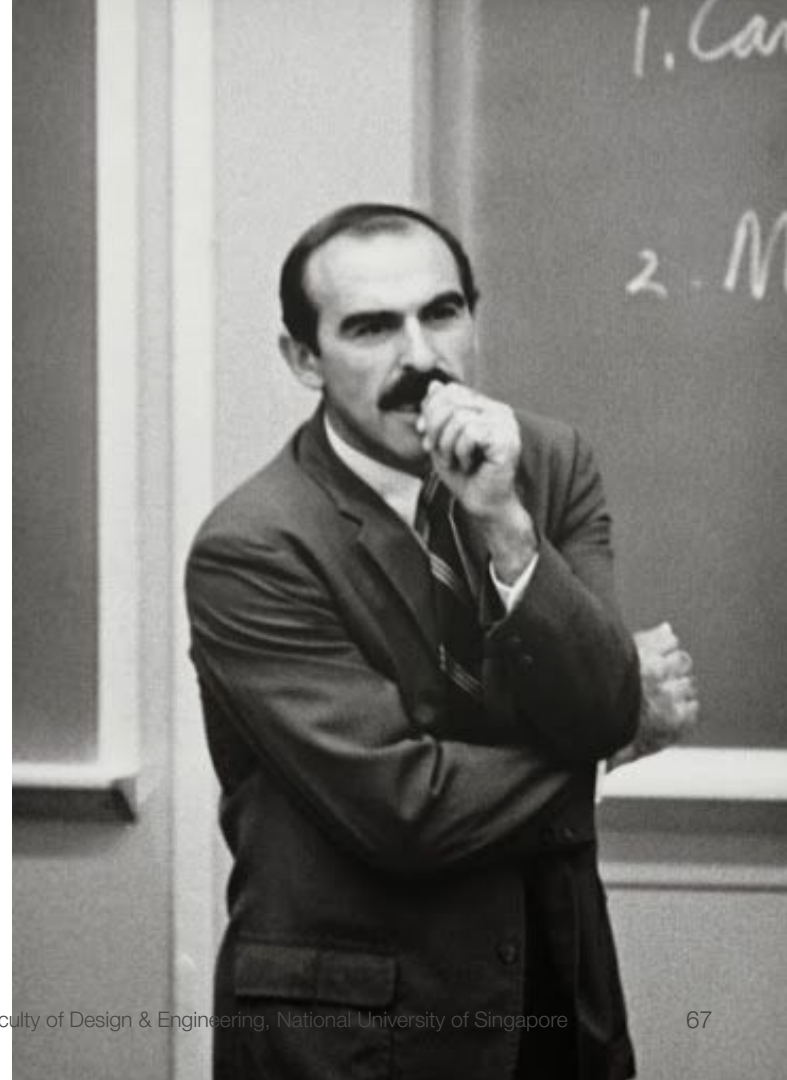






PEOPLE DON'T WANT
TO BUY A QUARTER
INCH DRILL.
**THEY WANT A
QUARTER INCH HOLE.**

Theodore Levitt, HBS





JOBS TO BE DONE

Functional	Personal	Social
Shelves on to brick walls	Feel manly and 'the provider'	Be able to lend tools to my bro
Picture hooks on plaster walls	Appreciate quality engineering	Be seen known as a 'quality buyer'
Faster driving of screws for repairs	Know where tool design is at	But also as a 'value finder'
Fixing cupboards	Spend that gift voucher	Hang with blokes on a weekend



ASK WHY PEOPLE USE THAT
PRODUCT, NOT THAT BRAND.
THEY “**HIRE**” A PRODUCT TO
COMPLETE THEIR JOB.

- People **encounter situations** that drive and **shape their need** for solutions to these jobs.
- People have **criteria** (sometimes conscious, but generally not) to evaluate the success of a job.



Discover Ara

The first toothbrush with Artificial Intelligence helps you keep healthy teeth

Discover How







Fire



Hire

1. What is JTBD
2. Case Studies
- 3. JTBD Framework**
4. Exercise 1: Understand Needs
5. Exercise 2: JTBD Interview & Job Statement

Understand customer needs (value)





1. What is JTBD
2. Case Studies
3. JTBD Framework
- 4. Exercise 1: Understand Needs**
5. Exercise 2: JTBD Interview & Job Statement

Discover Customers Needs



What are the **Jobs** that customers are hiring these products to do?

JTBD Template 1

Functional	Emotional	Social

1. What is JTBD
2. Case Studies
3. JTBD Framework
4. Exercise 1: Understand Needs
- 5. Exercise 2: JTBD Interview & Job Statement**

INTERVIEW your partner about a purchase

a **significant purchase** they had made in the last few months

“What have you bought recently?”

- *INTERVIEW by using JTBD framework. 20 min*
- *Write a **Job Statement**. 5 min*



CHOOSE A
PURCHASE
THAT
MATTERED IN
THE LAST 3
MONTHS

Interview

Role Play

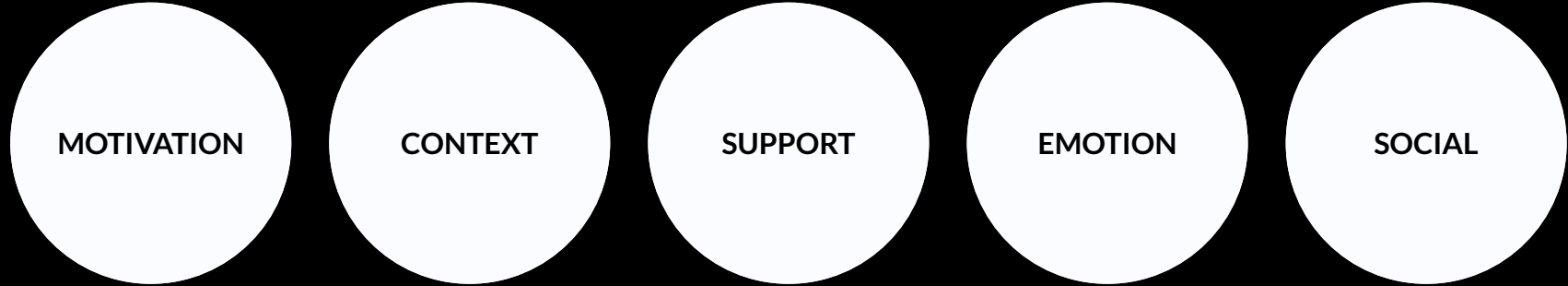
- Interviewer
- Interviewee
- Note taker
- Observer



Work as a team

Sharing tasks lets you divide focus onto different aspects and learn more in a limited time.





MOTIVATION

When did you
first think
about buying
something
like this?

Interviewee:

Describe when you first thought about buying something in this category.

Interviewer:

Listen for the needs.

CONTEXT



Tell me the story about buying this product.

Interviewee:

Describe the process of buying the product in rich detail. Help us understand each step.

Interviewer:

Listen to the story. Spot emotional decisions made.

SUPPORT



Why did you
buy this
product?

Interviewee:

**Describe why you bought this product.
What it is for. What it does for you.**

Interviewer:

Capture obvious jobs.

EMOTION



How do you
feel about
your purchase
now?

Interviewee:

Describe how this product or service makes you feel. How well it solves your needs.

Interviewer:

Listen for future opportunities.

SOCIAL

How did you
share your
buying story
with friends
and family?

Interviewee:

Did you tell other people about your purchase? How did they react? How did that make you feel?

Interviewer:

Listen for social jobs.

JTBD Job Statement #2

WHEN I BUT HELP ME SO I



What's the context?



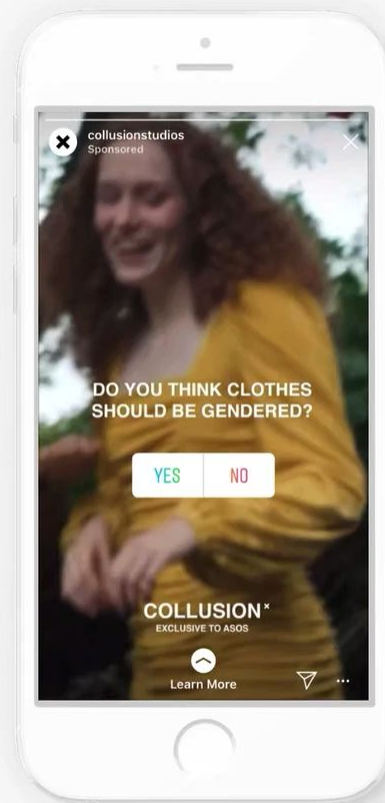
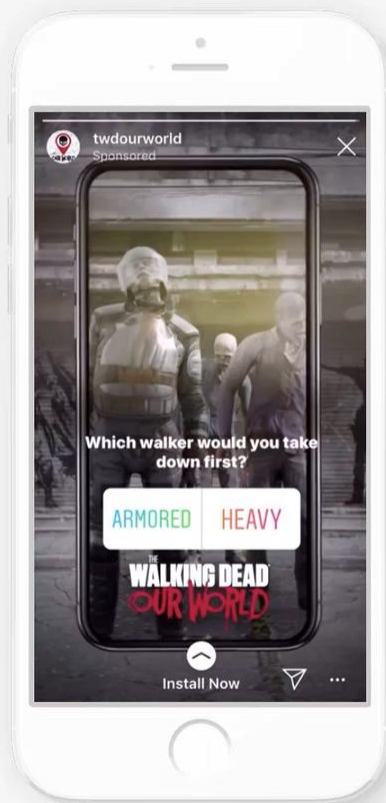
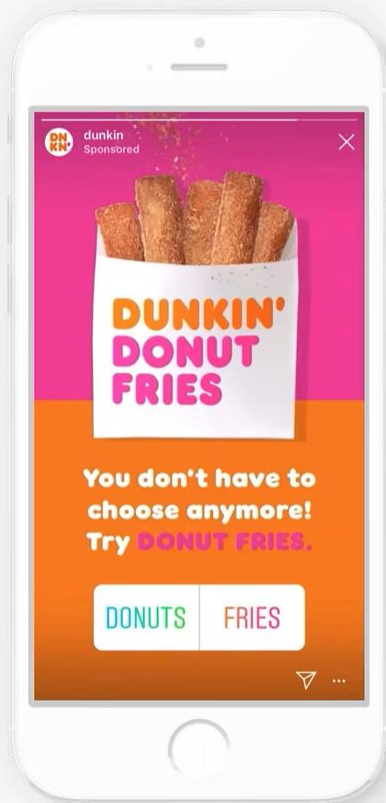
What's the barrier
getting in the way
today?



What is the user
trying to do?



What's the outcome of
achieving this action?



WHEN I BUT HELP ME SO I



What's the context?



What's the barrier
getting in the way
today?

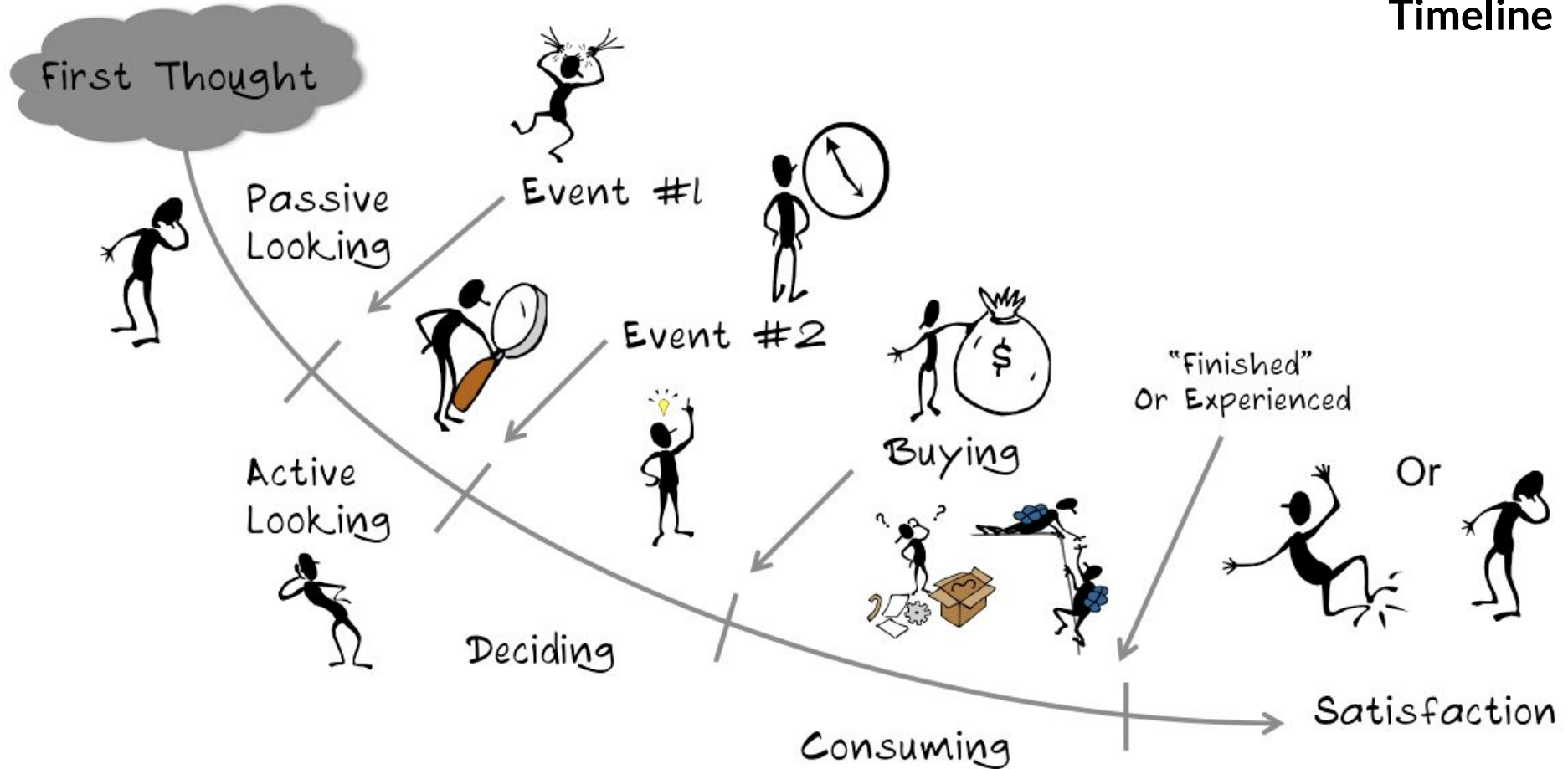


What is the user
trying to do?

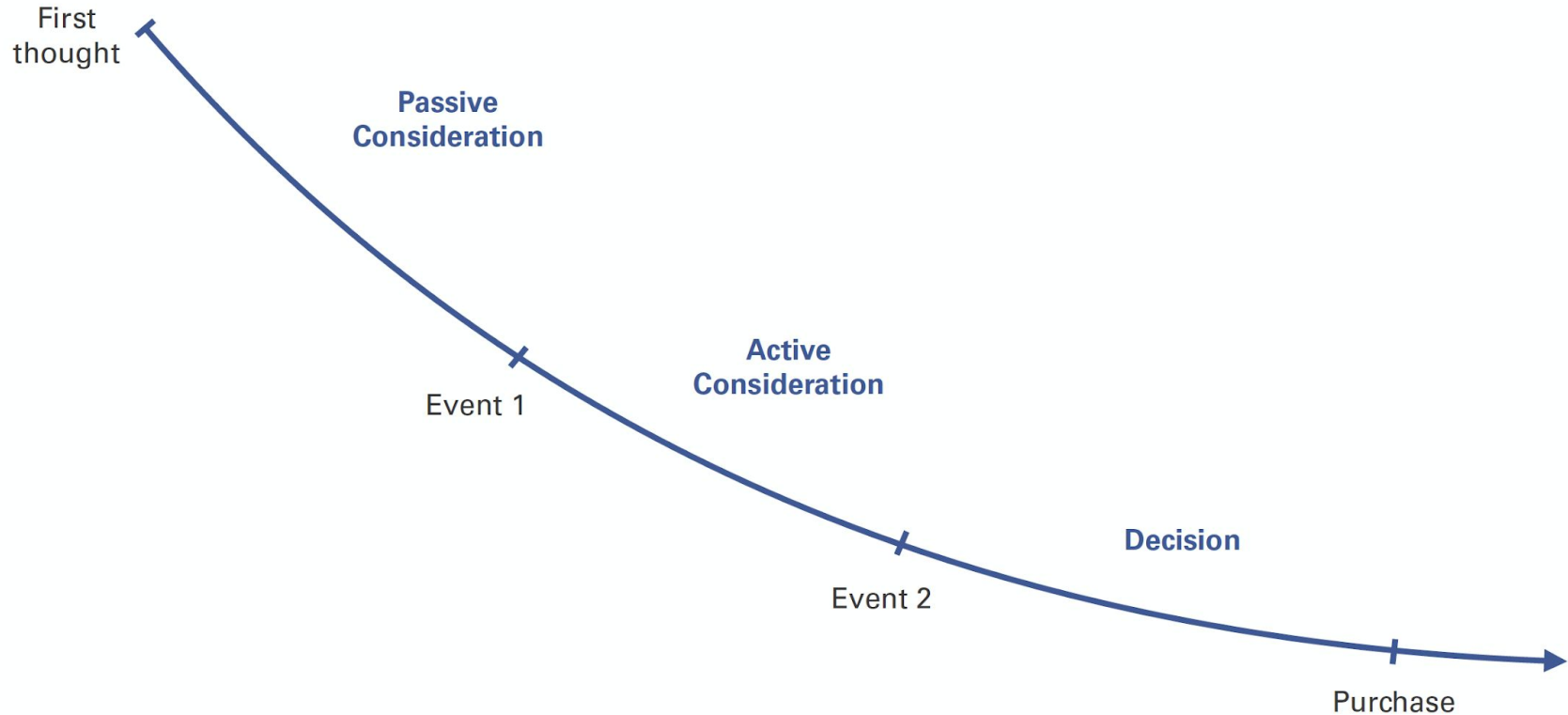


What's the outcome of
achieving this action?

Timeline



Timeline



Lecture 3 In-class Assignment Submission - JTBD Timeline

Name:

[Front]

First Thought (Passive Consideration)

Event 1 (Active Consideration)

Event 2 (Decision)

Purchase (Buying & Consuming)

[\[Back\]](#)

WHEN I ...

What's the context?

BUT ...

What's the barrier getting in the way today?

HELP ME ...

What is the user trying to do?

SO I ...

What's the outcome of achieving this action?

Why is JTBD important now?

- Companies are trying to find ways to avoid being disrupted
- Digital has provided new ways to solve jobs
- Differentiating around the customer rather than the product in an increasingly commoditized world
- Everything as a service

Why using this framework?

- JTBD gives a common language to work from.
- JTBD focuses teams' product development efforts.
- JTBD helps anticipate customers' needs and enable to leapfrog competition.
- JTBD keeps about delivering value.